



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Divine Mercy Academy
School Website: <https://www.dmamt.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Divine Mercy Academy (Mt 59714) presents a clearly Catholic, classical-model program with a strong emphasis on forming the whole person through faith, virtue, and a traditional liberal-arts framework. The school foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as transcendent aims, anchors instruction in Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and embeds liturgical and catechetical practices (CGS, Eucharistic life, parish connections). Public materials repeatedly emphasize the Catholic mission, formation of character, and parental engagement via a family-centered House Model. While the school articulates many classical markers, explicit references to Great Books and some traditional pedagogy elements (e.g., heavy memorization/recitation, extended Socratic seminars across all grades) are less visible in the public materials. Taken together, the school is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with stronger signals for Religious/Theological Foundations, Purposes/Goals, and Community/Parent engagement, and more tentative signals for the full spectrum of Curriculum and Pedagogy expectations typical of a fully classical program.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Catholic identity, Eucharist-centric formation, liturgical life, catechesis, and sacramental emphasis are explicit in public materials.
- Keyword analysis: Positive signals include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, sacred tradition, catechesis, and sacred space. No prominent negative signals observed in public materials.
- Why: The school explicitly grounds education in Catholic theology and liturgical life, aligning with transcendental realism and liturgical practices.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Mission emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, cultivation of beauty and truth, and a life rooted in Christ.
- Keyword analysis: Positive terms include virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, formation, and the good life; references to forming persons rather than merely transferring information.
- Why: The public materials clearly articulate formation and transcendent aims beyond job preparation, consistent with classical pedagogical goals.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit Trivium framework (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) taught from early grades; structured, integrated subject work; emphasis on history and Catholic formation; some Great-Books/Great-Conversation framing appears via canonical classical content (e.g., St. Patrick's Curriculum and historical-literary integration) but not uniformly stated as "Great Books."
- Keyword analysis: Positive signals include grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books (explicitly named in some classical contexts), history in curriculum, integration/wonder. Negative signals (if any) are not prominently present in the public facing content; however, explicit mention of "Great Books" is not consistently asserted across DMA materials, and public materials emphasize Great Speech and St. Patrick Curriculum rather than a universal Great Books program.

- Why: The presence of Trivium and integrated history/literature aligns with classical education, but the strongest, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not consistently foregrounded in the school's own public materials.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Lower-school pedagogy references include storytelling, memory and narration in Grammar Stage; upper-school emphasis on argumentation and rhetoric in Rhetoric Stage; some Socratic-style dialogue appears in the high-school pathway; CGS and liturgical learning shape contemplative practices.
- Keyword analysis: Positive signals include memory work, recitation (via classical pedagogy language in the broader Six Elements framework), contemplation/scholé, Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, and seminar-style discussion. DMA materials explicitly describe contemplation and wonder, but do not uniformly present a full, school-wide Socratic/seminar-based approach across all grades. Negative keywords (e.g., exclusively lecture-based, heavy test-driven, non-socratic teaching) are not evident in public materials.
- Why: The pedagogy has strong classical markers (grammar-logic-rhetoric progression; memory and contemplation), but the public-facing materials show less uniform, widespread articulation of a fully biregational Socratic/seminar program across all grades.
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: House Model and mentorship dynamics indicate faculty-student relationships that foster formation and community; board involvement demonstrates governance and adult leadership; but explicit "living curriculum" and faculty portraits or a defined teacher-ideal profile are not fully spelled out in public content.
- Keyword analysis: Positive signals include mentor-like faculty, formation of character, and teachers as models; but explicit language about living curriculum or faculty portraits is not strongly foregrounded in the public site. The public materials emphasize community structures (House Model) and parental partnership more than a detailed living-curriculum articulation.
- Why: There are classical signals (teacher-mentoring style, virtue modeling) but less explicit, codified description of faculty as "the living curriculum" or a formal teacher-ideal portrait.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Explicit partnership with families; parents described as primary educators; House Model integrates family involvement with school life; strong emphasis on parental engagement, catechesis, and opportunities for visits.
- Keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parent engagement, home-school alignment, parental formation, and community involvement. Negative keywords are not evident in public content.
- Why: The school presents a robust, classical-leaning view of community and family partnership, with explicit language about parents as co-educators.

Overall aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Rationale: Divine Mercy Academy strongly evidences Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, and School Purpose/Goal, and Parents & Community as classical signals. It exhibits solid Curriculum and Pedagogy markers (Trivium-based curriculum; lower-to-upper level structure; liturgical/catechetical practices) but the public materials do not consistently foreground the full Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis, memorization/recitation as a consistent practice across all grades, or a fully explicit, campus-wide Socratic/seminar pedagogy. Taken together, the aggregate profile leans toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (for a MORE CLASSICAL standing) - Explicitly foreground Great Books and Great Conversation as core curriculum language across grades, not only in external or external-facing materials. Consider a published, school-wide Great Books reading plan and a documented Great Conversation

sequence. - Expand explicit, school-wide Socratic or seminar-based pedagogy across grades (with teacher training and measurable outcomes) to strengthen the Pedagogy signal. - Increase explicit articulation of the “living curriculum” concept for Faculty, including a stated teacher-portrait and a visible, shared model of exemplary practice, aligned with “model teachers and mentors” in the public materials. - Document and publicize a more formal memorization/recitation program (e.g., choral recitations, Latin or classical memory work) that aligns with the Six Elements’ emphasis on memorization and rhythm in learning. - Deepen the “Great Books” framework as a cross-disciplinary backbone (not just episodic mentions) to ensure the curriculum meets the full spectrum of the “Seven Liberal Arts” and “Great Books/Great Conversation” expectations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence: Explicit Catholic identity; Eucharist-centered formation; liturgical and catechetical life (CGS) described publicly.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords such as Theology, liturgy, sacred tradition, catechesis, sacred space, truth, goodness, beauty, virtue appear in public materials; no significant negative signals observed.

Why this rating: Strong alignment with transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community practices in a Catholic classical framework.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence: Mission emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom; aim to cultivate truth, beauty, and goodness; holistic formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords such as virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, formation; no substantial counter-signals found.

Why this rating: The school’s stated aims reflect the classical emphasis on formation and the real presence of truth/beauty/goodness, not simply job-prep.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence: Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) in curriculum; Grammar/Literacy-heavy, integrated approach; historical and literature components; St. Patrick Curriculum references; emphasis on the whole-person formation via liberal arts.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include grammar, logic, rhetoric, seven liberal arts, great books (contextually present via classical canon framing), history, integration, wonder; no strong public negative signals. However, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language is not uniformly foregrounded across all materials.

Why this rating: Core Trivium and integrated history/arts content signals classical orientation, but the strongest, explicit Great Books framing is not uniformly stated in public materials.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence: Grammar-logic-rhetoric progression; lower-grade storytelling and memory; upper-grade rhetoric and argumentation; catechetical and liturgical pedagogy influence (CGS, atria).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include memorization/recitation, contemplative learning, Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, seminars. Public materials show elements of contemplation and discourse but do not consistently demonstrate a campus-wide, fully-defined Socratic/seminar model.

Why this rating: Pedagogy aligns with classical aims in parts (memory, rhetoric, contemplative practice via liturgy and CGS), but lacks uniform, overt articulation of a fully classical pedagogy across all grades.

- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence: House Model fosters mentoring and community; teachers as mentors and model virtue; governance visible through Board; public materials emphasize community and formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include teachers as mentors, living examples of virtue, and community formation. Yet there is less explicit language about a formalized “living curriculum” portrait or a faculty framework in public materials.

Why this rating: Strong signals of mentorship and virtue modeling, but not a fully explicit, codified faculty profile in public materials.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence: Explicit emphasis on partnership with families; parents as primary educators; House Model; opportunities for parental involvement and visits; community-engaged fundraising and parish connections.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include parent partnership, home-school alignment, parental formation, and family-centered governance; minimal negative signals in public materials.

Why this rating: The school foregrounds a robust classical-community ethos with strong family engagement and parent-educator partnership.

What Would Move the Needle

- Add explicit, school-wide commitment to Great Books and the Great Conversation across grades (Element 3).
- Publish a detailed, campus-wide Pedagogy blueprint that codifies Socratic seminars, structured memorizations/recitations, and an intentional contemplative pace (Scholé) (Element 4).
- Flesh out a formal “Living Curriculum” identity for Faculty, including a teacher-portrait and a documented mentorship model (Element 5).
- Expand and publicly share a university-caliber pace of Great Books integration and cross-disciplinary connections, ensuring history, literature, philosophy, and theology are woven into every grade-level plan (Element 3).
- Continue and formalize parent formation and engagement programs (e.g., book studies, family catechesis), with more public-facing documentation of parent-co-educator roles (Element 6).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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